

Controlled Substance Waste and Witnessing Policy

Policy Number: MED-POL-2024-001

Effective Date: January 1, 2024

Last Revised: September 2024

Scope: St. Luke's Health System - All Facilities

1. Purpose

This policy establishes procedures for the proper destruction and witnessing of controlled substances, particularly Schedule II (CII) medications, to ensure compliance with federal and state regulations, prevent medication diversion, and maintain accurate records of all controlled substance transactions.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all licensed healthcare providers, pharmacy technicians, and nursing staff at St. Luke's Health System facilities who handle, prepare, administer, or dispose of controlled substances.

3. Policy

3.1 CII Medication Waste Requirements

Mandatory Requirement: All waste or return of Schedule II (CII) controlled substances must be witnessed by a second licensed healthcare provider (RN, LPN, or other authorized provider).

This requirement applies to:

- Partial doses that cannot be safely administered
- Unused portions of previously opened vials or ampules
- Medications that have expired or been discontinued
- Medications damaged or contaminated during handling

3.2 Witness Requirements

Witness Qualifications: The witnessing provider must:

- Be a licensed healthcare provider (not ancillary staff)
- Have a valid DEA license and current prescriptive authority
- Independently verify the medication, strength, and quantity being wasted
- Document their full name and credentials in the waste record
- Physically observe the entire waste/destruction process

3.3 Documentation Requirements

All controlled substance waste must be documented within the Omnicell system with the following information:

Required Field	Details
Witness Name and ID	Full name and employee ID of witnessing provider
Date and Time	Exact timestamp of waste disposal
Medication Name	Generic and brand name if applicable
Strength and Quantity	Dose amount and unit of measure
Reason for Waste	Specific reason (e.g., patient refused, expired, contaminated)
DEA Form 106	Reference number if required by pharmacy

3.4 Waste Destruction Methods

CII medications must be destroyed using one of the following approved methods:

- **Approved Chemical Destruction:** Omnicell ChemLock pouches or similar DEA-approved kits that render the medication non-recoverable
- **Pharmacy Destruction:** Return to pharmacy for destruction via incineration or DEA-approved waste disposal
- **Toilet Flushing:** Only if medication is on the FDA flush list; documented and witnessed

4. Audit and Compliance

The Diversion Support Team will conduct monthly audits of controlled substance waste records, with particular attention to:

- Waste transactions lacking a documented witness
- Witness credentials not verified in the system
- Frequency of waste by employee or unit
- Reasons for waste discrepancies

Any waste record found to be non-compliant will trigger an immediate investigation.

5. Violations and Disciplinary Action

Violations of this policy may result in:

- Immediate suspension of controlled substance access pending investigation
- Mandatory retraining on controlled substance handling
- Formal disciplinary action up to and including termination
- Report to professional licensing boards
- Referral to law enforcement or DEA as appropriate

6. References

- 21 CFR 1304.23: Records of controlled substances destruction
- State Board of Nursing regulations on controlled substance handling
- St. Luke's Medication Management Policy
- Omnicell System Administration Guidelines

Policy Approved By: Pharmacy Director, Chief Nursing Officer

This is a synthetic sample document created for training and demonstration purposes.